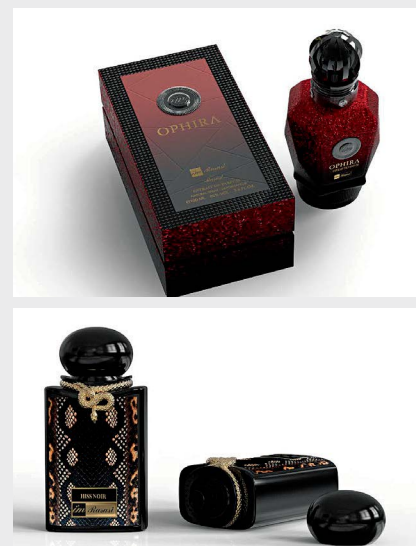




Noting how consumption behaviours vary sharply across generations, Imtiyaz observes that classics like Rasasi's Blue Lady and Blue for Men fragrances have stood the test of time for 45 years, and are beloved by middle-aged and older users who stick to one scent for ages. Gen Z, however, craves freshness and change: "What they use in the morning changes by evening."

Accordingly, the lineup includes both classics and new-age fragrances. These include, among others, Ophira, which features notes of Madagascar vanilla, coffee and Indonesian patchouli leaf; Burned Sugar, a blend of toasted sweetness, golden resins, and boozy fruit; and the Aged Infusion, combining a base of musk and tonka bean with bursts of rosemary, juniper and lime. The name I'm Rasasi is both an introduction and an offering – allowing consumers to not only know but also become the brand.

In his view, knowing your consumer and their demand is the greatest challenge business owners face. "Companies are overproducing, assuming demand is doubling or tripling," Imtiyaz explains. "But it's not increasing—it's shifting. My production capacity is fixed, so I must pinpoint actual demand to match supply precisely." Imtiyaz classifies I'm Rasasi as an aspirational upper mid-market brand, distinct from niche and premium offerings as well as mass market brands. Focusing on Rasasi's core fragrance business, Imtiyaz reveals the concepts

that drive the brand: "value, fashion, affordable luxury, and fashion in perfume." Innovation is key too—each perfume must tell a story, create recall, and build lasting brand memory. Without these fundamentals, "you're not justifying your own brand and business." The Unlike many other industries where retail has shifted from brick-and-mortar shops to online direct-to-consumer (D2C) models, Imtiyaz insists that the fragrance industry demands a hybrid model. While a fragrance itself is intangible, the experience of buying fragrance is a profoundly tangible one. Showrooms are essential for branding and experience—consumers must smell it first. "Once they smell and get attached, they convert to online," he says. For this reason, even if

online sales account for a share of the sales, Imtiyaz predicts that the brick-and-mortar model is here to stay.

Geographically, the Americas account for the highest portion of Rasasi's market. The company recently exhibited at Miami Cosmo, a leading event in North America that features major skincare, fragrance and hair and nails brands, and met its American customers. The Middle East follows ("Arabs love perfumes from morning to night"). India is also maturing as a perfume market. "Ten years ago, people sprayed deo on clothes. Now, the awareness has grown; they discuss niche, premium, ingredients—like an international audience." He teases: "Rasasi Imtiyaz Group is entering India—just wait."

